



His address was followed by the first panel discussion of the evening, on New-Age Women Leaders, which was joined by Dipali Goenka, CEO & Joint Managing Director, Welspun India; Jyoti Deshpande, CEO, Viacom18; Anjali Bansal, Founder, Avaana Capital; and Priti Rathi Gupta, Founder, LXME. The panel was moderated by Aabha Bakaya, Senior Editor & Presenter, *Business Today* TV. The panel said that women counted themselves out for certain jobs, which is one of the main reasons why there aren't enough of them in middle management and leader-

ship positions, despite educational institutions having a stronger representation of women. For this to change, the families—and, in particular, the men of the family—have to come on board.

After the first panel discussion, the audience were treated to an insightful video message from one of the world's most iconic female business leaders, Sheryl Sandberg, COO of Meta (Facebook). Addressing the winners at the event, Sandberg said they were an inspiration to millions of girls in India and in the world, that they too can dream big. She felt that inspira-

tion is needed now more than ever because women are more likely to have lost their jobs or got a pay cut because of the pandemic. Globally, women-run businesses saw more closures than those run by men, simply because women had to take on extra caring responsibilities.

Sandberg's address was then followed by a fireside chat with K.V. Kamath, Chairperson, National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development, and former honcho of ICICI Bank, where he was one of the flag bearers of gender diversity, bringing to the fore a strong senior leader-